

INR2002: Introduction to International Relations

0002 — Summer B 2026

Instructor Information

Name: Caroline Robbins

Office: Bellamy (BEL) 223

Email: crobbsins@fsu.edu

Office Hours: Wednesdays 11:30-12:30 or by appointment

Class Information

Dates: June 22 - July 31

Time: 9:45 AM - 11:00 AM Weekdays (Mon-Fri)

Classroom: Bellamy (BEL) 0004

Course Description

This course introduces students to the study of international relations. Using international relations as the focus, students will understand basic political and social science principles. Students will develop a foundational understanding of the different actors that participate in international relations and the different goals they pursue, the processes of conflict and cooperation, and recent trends in international politics.

Course Objectives

After this course, you should be able to:

- Understand current and historical events in world politics and the impact on international relations practices.
- Explain how theories of international relations can explain the causes of conflict.
- Explain why countries engage in international economic exchange.
- Demonstrate how international law is formed and its effects on international relations and domestic policy.

Required Materials

Textbook: *World Politics: Interests, Interactions, and Institutions, 5th Edition*. 2022. Frieden, J, Lake, D., and Schultz, K. W.W. Norton Press.

The textbook is available through FSU's bookstore or other local and online marketplaces. It is a required material for this course!

University Attendance Policy

Excused absences include documented illness, deaths in the family, and other documented crises, call to active military duty or jury duty, religious holy days, and official University activities. These absences will be accommodated in a way that does not arbitrarily penalize students who have a valid written excuse. Consideration will also be given to students whose dependent children experience serious illness.

Academic Honor Policy

The Florida State University Academic Honor Policy outlines the University's expectations for the integrity of students' academic work, the procedures for resolving alleged violations of those expectations, and the rights and responsibilities of students and faculty members throughout the process. Students are responsible for reading the Academic Honor Policy and for living up to their pledge to . . . be honest and truthful and . . . [to] strive for personal and institutional integrity at Florida State University. (Florida State University Academic Honor Policy, found at fda.fsu.edu/academic-resources/academic-integrity-and-grievances/academic-honor-policy)

Email Policy

I will primarily respond to students through email. If you have additional questions about the course or material, want to schedule office hours, or have another professional request, you can reach me at crobbins@fsu.edu. Please note - I will respond to your email as soon as possible, but it will not always be instantaneous. Please allow 24-48 hours for an email response. If you do not hear back from me within 48 hours, feel free to send another email or speak to me before or after class. Do not email at 11:50 PM asking about how to complete an assignment that is due at 11:59 PM, you will not receive a response until it is too late.

Late Work Policy

I will accept late work that is submitted within 24 hours of the original deadline for half-credit. This means if an assignment is due on Wednesday, and a student submits it on Thursday, the maximum score they can receive on the assignment is a 50%. Most of our assignments will be completed in class and you will have a full academic week to complete all homework assignments. This course moves very quickly, so please keep the deadlines we have in mind!

If you have an excused absence or note explaining extenuating circumstances that prevented you from submitting an assignment on time, please reach out to me directly and I will allow for late submission with no penalty.

Phone and Device Policies

You are permitted to use some devices for note-taking or referencing the textbook online (e.g., laptops, iPads) during class. You may *only* use them for course materials. This course moves very quickly, and online distractions during class time will negatively impact your performance. Please have all devices on silent while you are in class. Phone use is not permitted, barring emergency

circumstances. If you need to record the classes in accordance with HB233, please speak to me after the first day of class. You can refer to the section on HB233 for further details.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy

In this course, you may use AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot) as *support tools* **NOT** as substitutes for your own thinking or analysis. Your submitted work must reflect your independent understanding and be consistent with course learning goals.

Permitted Uses: You can use AI to clarify concepts from the reading or lectures (e.g., "Please explain XYZ in simpler terms"). You can also use it for minor grammatical checks (e.g., Grammarly's spelling and grammar checking functions).

Prohibited Uses: Write or substantially generate any graded submission you present as your own (papers, responses, exams, discussion posts). Produce citations, quotations, or "facts" without verifying them using credible sources (AI has a tendency to fabricate and hallucinate information). Submit AI generated text that you cannot explain or defend in class or in a academic honor code meeting with the instructor.

Disclosure Requirement: If you use AI for any graded assignment, include an AI Use Statement at the end of your submission. Format it as so:

Tool Used: (name/version if known)

Use: Detail how you used AI (e.g., outlines, summaries, editing, brainstorming)

Prompts: What prompts or inputs you used (paste the exact prompt given to the AI)

Verification: Describe what you checked (list any additional sources of verifying information)

You are responsible for the accuracy of all claims, data, citations, and their attribution. AI is **NOT** a citable academic source. Being unable to explain or defend your reasoning, evidence, and conclusions may contribute to a finding of prohibited AI usage.

If you are found to have violated the AI policy stated here, either by improper usage or failure to disclose proper usage, you will receive a grade of "0" on the assignment and a referral to the University's Academic Dishonesty procedure as a violation of the Academic Honor Code.

Homework Assignments

In this course, you will have five homework assignments corresponding to each main week. Assignments will be posted on Mondays and due on the subsequent Friday of the same week. Students must complete these assignments individually. All assignment instructions will be posted to Canvas, and students will submit assignments on Canvas. Failure to submit an assignment on time will lead to a reduced score in accordance with the Late Work Policy specified in the syllabus.

Exit Tickets

Each class, Mondays-Thursdays, students will complete a short reflection Exit Ticket discussing and applying the lessons learned from the lectures and the readings. These will be open-ended questions that will be written by the student and turned in to the instructor at the end of class. The instructor will allow for time to complete each Exit Ticket during class. On Fridays, the Exit Ticket

will be a short, multiple-choice quiz based on the unit material from that week. These quizzes will help the students prepare for the final exam of the course. Quizzes will be graded after class and returned to the students the next Monday. The only exception is the final week of classes, where students will complete the Final Exam instead of their Exit Ticket.

Exams

There is only one exam in this course, administered to students during the final week of classes. This exam is cumulative and will test students' retention of the course material. It will be multiple choice, taken with a pencil and paper in class on the day of the scheduled exam. Students will have the full time to complete the exam. A study guide for the exam will be provided to students on Monday the week before the exam. Students should expect the exam to be challenging, but not difficult if they have studied, completed the prior course material (Exit Tickets and Assignments), and have reached out to clarify anything they are uncertain about.

Grading

The course grade is determined by the following components:

Participation in Class	20%
Homework Assignments	20%
Exit Tickets	30%
Final Exam	30%

Grade Scale

Final grades will be assigned according to the following percentage scale:

A	93 – 100	C+	77 – 79
A–	90 – 92	C	73 – 76
B+	87 – 89	C–	70 – 72
B	83 – 86	D	60 – 69
B–	80 – 82	F	0 – 59

I will regularly update your grades in Canvas, but if you have any questions about your standing in the class, please do not hesitate to reach out. If your grade sits at a 0.5-0.9 threshold (i.e., 89.5), I will round up to the nearest whole number. I will *not* round more than a single percentage point (i.e., I will not round an 86 to a 90).

Student Success Resources

Free Tutoring from FSU

On-campus tutoring and writing assistance is available for many courses at Florida State University. A comprehensive list of on-campus tutoring options is available at tutoring.fsu.edu. High-quality tutoring is available by appointment and on a walk-in basis. These services are offered by tutors

trained to encourage the highest level of individual academic success while upholding personal academic integrity.

Americans With Disabilities Act

FSU is committed to providing reasonable accommodation for all persons with disabilities in a manner that is consistent with the academic standards of the course while empowering the student to meet the integral requirements of the course. Students with disabilities needing academic accommodation should: (1) register with and provide documentation to the Office of Accessibility Services; and (2) request a letter from the Office of Accessibility Services to be sent to the instructor indicating the need for accommodation and what type; and (3) meet (in person, via phone, email, zoom, etc...) with each instructor to whom a letter of accommodation was sent to review approved accommodations. Please note that instructors are not allowed to provide classroom accommodations to a student until appropriate verification from the Office of Accessibility Services has been provided. This syllabus and other class materials are available in an alternative format upon request. For the latest version of this statement and more information about services available to FSU students with disabilities, contact the:

Office of Accessibility Services
874 Traditions Way
108 Student Services Building
Florida State University
Tallahassee, FL 32306-4167
(850) 644-9566 (voice)
(850) 644-8504 (TDD)
oas@fsu.edu
dsst.fsu.edu/oas

Student Health and Success

Your academic success is a top priority for Florida State University. University resources to help you succeed include tutoring centers, computer labs, counseling and health services, and services for designated groups, such as veterans and students with disabilities. The following information is not exhaustive, so please check with your advisor or the Department of Student Support and Transitions to learn more.

Confidential Campus Resources:

Various centers and programs are available to assist students with navigating stressors that might impact academic success. These include the following:

Victim Advocate Program
University Center A, Rm. 4100
(850) 644-7161
Available 24/7/365
Office Hours: M-F 8-5
dsst.fsu.edu/vap

Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS)

Florida State University's Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) primary mission is to address psychological needs and personal concerns, which may interfere with students' academic progress, social development, and emotional well-being. The following in-person and virtual (tele-mental health) services are available to all enrolled students residing in the state of Florida:

1. Individual therapy
 2. Group therapy
 3. Crisis Intervention
 4. Psychoeducational and outreach programming
 5. After hours crisis-hotline
 6. Access to community providers for specialized treatment
- Call 850-644-TALK (8255) for more information on how to initiate services.

Counseling and Psychological Services

250 Askew Student Life Center

942 Learning Way

(850) 644-TALK (8255)

Walk-in and Appointment Hours:

M-F 8 am - 4 pm

counseling.fsu.edu

Additional Health Services:

Services at UHS are available to all enrolled students residing in Florida: The mission of University Health Services (UHS) is to promote and improve the overall health and well-being of FSU students. UHS provides a coordinated continuum of care through prevention, intervention, and treatment. Services include general medical care, priority care, gynecological services, physicals, allergy injection clinic, immunizations, diagnostic imaging, physical therapy, and a medical response unit. The Center for Health Advocacy and Wellness (CHAW) assists students in their academic success through individual, group, and population-based health and wellness initiatives. Topics include wellness, alcohol and other drugs, hazing prevention, nutrition and body image, sexual health, and power based personal violence prevention. For more information, go to uhs.fsu.edu.

University Health Services

Health and Wellness Center

960 Learning Way

Tallahassee, FL 32306

Hours: M-F, 8 am - 4 pm

(850) 644-6230

uhs.fsu.edu

Statement on Public Health Protocols

During any adverse event or condition that threatens our University community, please look for specific information on the FSU Alerts page (<https://alerts.fsu.edu/>) to ascertain particulars to the current situation. Please be patient with one another while we navigate any ongoing challenge. Whatever happens, we are committed to helping you learn the material thoroughly and stay on schedule with your degree program.

Statement for Classes Subject to HB233 Recording

In this class, consistent with state law and university policy, students are permitted to make recordings of class lectures for personal use only. As noted, sharing, posting, or publishing classroom recordings may subject you to honor code violations and legal penalties associated with theft of intellectual property and violations of other state laws. Moreover, students and educators have expressed concern that recording classroom activities may negatively impact the learning experience for others, especially in classes that involve questions, discussion, or participation. To protect a learning environment in which everyone feels free to experiment with ideas, we ask you to refrain from recording in ways that could make others feel reluctant to ask questions, explore new ideas, or otherwise participate in class. Students must monitor their recordings so that they do not include participation by other students without permission. Students with disabilities will continue to have appropriate accommodations for recordings as established by the Office of Accessibility Services.

Syllabus Change Policy

Except for changes that substantially affect implementation of the evaluation (grading) statement, this syllabus is a guide for the course and is subject to change with advance notice.

I will notify all students about any changes to the syllabus via Canvas and in class.

Important Dates

- Term Start: June 22
- Financial Aid/Academic Drop Deadline: June 25
- Academic Withdrawal Deadline: July 24
- Final Exam: July 31

Respect Policy

I respect your time:

- I will come prepared to help you understand the course material, answer any questions that you have, and help prepare you for understanding both the course material and how it can benefit you as a student.
- Communication is key: I cannot help you if I do not know what is going on. Please reach out if you are unsure about anything, even if you think your question is small!
- I will not make any adjustments to the class or schedule that would cause more stress on you. Any changes will be in your favor.

Respect my time:

- Be on time to class. We only have six weeks together, and there is a lot of material. It is hard for me to help you understand if you frequently miss parts of the lecture.

- Pay attention when I am talking to you. I will do the same when you have questions or concerns.
- Come to class prepared by doing the work and going to office hours when you need help. I have tried to design this class to be efficient and effective, but your engagement with the material is crucial.
- Do not turn in AI-generated or plagiarized work. You should turn in work that is yours, as it is necessary to help you understand the material.

Respect each other:

- Do not be disruptive. If you need to take a call or text someone, step outside for a minute and then return once you are finished.
- Allow one another to make mistakes. This is an important part of the learning process.
- Use respectful language when talking with one another. We are going to discuss issues that are very sensitive and deal with difficult subjects in international policy. Name-calling, shaming, yelling, or otherwise hurtful or demeaning language will not be tolerated.

Tentative Schedule

The following is a *tentative* schedule for the course.

- Week of June 22: An Introduction to International Relations
 - Monday: Course Overview and Expectations; What is "International Relations?"
 - * Before Class: Read the syllabus, check in on Canvas page, purchase textbook
 - * After Class: Assignment 1 posted to Canvas (due Friday)
 - Tuesday: A Brief History of International Relations
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 1 of the textbook
 - Wednesday: What are Interests, Interactions, and Institutions?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 2 of the textbook
 - Thursday: Introduction to Bargaining Models
 - * Before Class: Review Chapters 1-2 of the textbook
 - Friday: Applications and Discussion
 - * Before Class: Submit Assignment 1
 - * During Class: Exit Ticket Quiz
- Week of June 29: Why Do Wars Happen? Conflict and Bargaining
 - Monday: Why Do (International) Wars Happen?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 3 of the textbook
 - * After Class: Assignment 2 posted to Canvas (due Friday)
 - Tuesday: Why Do Domestic Politics Matter in War?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 4 of the textbook
 - Wednesday: Democratic Peace Theory
 - * Before Class: Review Chapter 4 of the textbook
 - Thursday: Alliances and Entanglement
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 5 of the textbook
 - Friday: Applications and Discussion
 - * Before Class: Submit Assignment 2
 - * During Class: Exit Ticket Quiz
- Week of July 6: Continued Conflict and Terrorism
 - Monday: International Institutions and War Prevention
 - * Before Class: Review Chapter 5 of the textbook
 - * After Class: Assignment 3 posted to Canvas (due Friday)
 - Tuesday: What is a Non-State Actor?
 - * Before Class: Read the first half of Chapter 6 of the textbook
 - Wednesday: What is Civil Conflict?
 - * Before Class: Read (or review) all of Chapter 6 of the textbook

- Thursday: What is Terrorism?
 - * Before Class: Review Chapter 6 of the textbook
- Friday: Applications and Discussion
 - * Before Class: Submit Assignment 3
 - * During Class: Exit Ticket Quiz
- Week of July 13: Why Does Trade Matter? International Political Economy
 - Monday: What is International Trade?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 7 of the textbook
 - * After Class: Assignment 4 posted to Canvas (due Friday)
 - Tuesday: Foreign Direct Investment and International Finance
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 8 of the textbook
 - Wednesday: Exchange Rates and Currency Collapse
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 9 of the textbook
 - Thursday: What Makes a Wealthy Nation?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 10 of the textbook
 - Friday: Applications and Discussion
 - * Before Class: Submit Assignment 4
 - * During Class: Exit Ticket Quiz
- Week of July 20: International Law and Globalization
 - Monday: What is International Law?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 11 of the textbook
 - * After Class: Assignment 5 posted to Canvas (due Friday)
 - Tuesday: What is the Difference Between Laws and Norms?
 - * Before Class: Review Chapter 11 of the textbook
 - Wednesday: What are Human Rights?
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 12 of the textbook
 - Thursday: The Global Environment
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 13 of the textbook
 - Friday: Applications and Discussion
 - * Before Class: Turn in Assignment 5
 - * During Class: Exit Ticket Quiz
- Week of July 27: Modern Challenges and Applications of International Relations
 - Monday: Cybersecurity and Digital International Relations
 - * Before Class: Read Chapter 14 of the textbook (specifically through page 632)
 - * After Class: Final Exam study guide posted to Canvas
 - Tuesday: Great Power Competition

- * Before Class: Read (or review) Chapter 14 of the textbook (specifically through page 644)
- Wednesday: Populism and Anti-Globalism
 - * Before Class: Read (or review) the last sections of Chapter 14.
- Thursday: Exam Review
 - * Before Class: Prepare any review materials!
- Friday: Final Exam!
 - * During Class: Final Exam